RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Senior Backend Engineer | Python and Go

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 21 years of experience building and operating large-scale services in Python, Go and C++. Designed high-throughput services and APIs, including an entitlement service handling 120k requests per second, and contributed to a migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services. Experienced with PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, event-driven systems, Kubernetes, observability and automated testing. Fluent in English.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform - Streamhaus GmbH (video streaming), Munich *2019 - Aug 2026*

- Led the platform organisation responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform; remained hands-on with internal tooling, including cost dashboard scripts.
- Drove migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Established service templates using FastAPI or Go, OpenTelemetry tracing, Prometheus metrics and Terraform modules.
- Built an internal cloud cost dashboard using BigQuery billing exports and Looker Studio; rightsizing and committed use discounts reduced cloud spend by 31% (EUR 4.2M/year).
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.

Principal Engineer - Streamhaus GmbH *2015 - 2019*

- Technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Tornado, Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed and wrote most of the Go entitlement service for subscriptions, regions and devices; handled 120k requests/second at peak with p99 latency under 15 ms using Cassandra and local in-memory caching.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer - Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart *2010 - 2015*

- Built backend systems for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led six developers on the route-history product.
- Co-inventor on a granted German patent for adaptive GPS sampling in vehicle fleets.

Software Engineer - Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe *2005 - 2010*

- Developed C++ and Python for industrial data acquisition software on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for eight years.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Open-source Python retry library | Maintainer, 2012 - 2018

- Maintained a Python retry library with approximately 1,500 GitHub stars; handed over maintenance in 2018.
- Technologies: Python, pytest, tox.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent MSc), Computer Science, Rhine Valley University | 2005

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, C++ (older experience)
Backend and APIs: FastAPI, Tornado, Django, Flask, asyncio, gRPC, Protobuf
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), Kubernetes, Terraform; AWS (EC2, S3)
Testing and observability: pytest, tox, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Other: Distributed systems design, architecture reviews, technical hiring, people management

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)

PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

- "Running Python at 100k rps" - EuroPython-style conference talk, 2018
- "Cost is a feature" - internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023